

Lesson 3

她不是學生 — She Is Not a Student

Let's Learn Mandarin · Book 1 · Teacher's Manual

壹. Learning Objectives

Theme: Occupation I

After completing this lesson, students will be able to use Chinese to:
1. Ask others whether someone is a student. 2. Ask others about their occupation and workplace. 3. Introduce their own and family members' marital status.

貳. Key Teaching Points and Activity Design

I. Warm-Up Activity

1. Activity method:

- 1. Use pictures to review kinship terms, and also introduce “兒子 (son)” and “女兒 (daughter).”
- 2. Review Lesson 2 grammar by asking students about family members and how many there are.
- 3. Use pictures to introduce “學生 (student)” and ask students whether their siblings are students.

2. Sentences to use:

- 你有_____ (兄弟姐妹) 嗎? / 你_____ (兄弟姐妹) 是學生嗎?
 - (Do you have _____ [siblings]? / Is your _____ [sibling] a student?)
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II. Vocabulary Instruction

1. “她 / 他” are third-person pronouns referring to females and males respectively, but “他” can also be used to refer to females. They are pronounced the same but written differently.
2. “哪裡” is an interrogative pronoun in Chinese used when asking about a location. In Chinese question sentences, the word order is exactly the same as in declarative sentences. “哪裡” and “哪兒” have the same meaning and usage.
3. The grammatical structures of “畢業了 (graduated)” and “結婚了 (got married)” are relatively difficult for beginning students, but they are highly practical, so this lesson does not explain their structures or the usage of “了.” Instead, they are taught directly as whole phrases — teachers should teach them as complete phrases and use substitution drills with the subject to practice. If students encounter “未結婚 (unmarried)” or “未畢業 (not yet graduated),” teachers can substitute “沒結婚” and “沒畢業” instead, without over-explaining.

◎ Teaching Method

For beginning-level vocabulary instruction, it is recommended to teach **from top to bottom, using sentences as the foundation, and using already-learned structures to introduce new vocabulary**. Additionally, use the concept of word groups for teaching activities to deepen students' impressions. For example: 兒子/女兒/孩子/小孩 (son/daughter/child/child), 學生/大學/小學 (student/university/elementary school), 銀行/電腦公司 (bank/computer company), etc.

III. Grammar Instruction

1. 不 (Negation)

“不” is one of the two main negative adverbs in Chinese. Placing “不” in front of a verb (such as 是, 姓, 叫) creates a negative sentence. For example:

- 我不是美國人。 (*I am not American.*)
 - 我不叫 Mary。 (*My name is not Mary.*)
-

2. 在 + place + V (Working/Studying at a Place)

The Chinese word order is: S (N) + 在 + place + V + (O). “在” is a preposition followed by a “place,” indicating the location of the work.

- S (N) + 在 + place + V + (O)
- 我在電腦公司工作。 (*I work at a computer company.*)
- 他在銀行工作。 (*He works at a bank.*)

◎ **Common student error:** Students may be influenced by their native language and place the “在 + place” phrase in the wrong position, such as at the end of the sentence. The teacher should provide more examples and drills, and avoid over-explaining. If students do not produce incorrect sentences, there is no need to specifically point this out.

3. 都 (Both/All)

When constructing sentences, “都” must always be placed before the verb. The people or things that “都” refers to must be plural and must have been mentioned in the preceding text or sentence. For example:

(1) S (plural N) + 都 + V + (O) - John 和 Mary 都是學生。 (*John and Mary are both students.*) - Gloria 和 Mary 都姓 Lee。 (*Gloria and Mary are both surnamed Lee.*)

(2) For negative sentences, add “不” before the verb: - S (plural N) + 都 + 不 + V + (O) - John 和 Mary 都不姓 Lee。 (*John and Mary are neither surnamed Lee.*) - 他們都不是學生。 (*They are all not students.*)

◎ **Common student error:** Placing “都” at the beginning of the sentence — e.g., 都他們不是學生。 (*incorrect*)

IV. Text Instruction

◆ Key Sentences

1. 我姊姊不是學生。 (*My older sister is not a student.*)

2. 我姊姊在銀行工作。(My older sister works at a bank.)
3. 我姊姊結婚了。(My older sister is married.)
4. 兩個小孩都在小學念書。(Both children study at elementary school.)

◆ Suggested Teaching Flow

1. The teacher takes on the role of Gloria Lee (character portraits and family pictures may be used) to produce some of the lesson's sentences. For example: “我是 Gloria。我姊姊不是學生，她在銀行工作。我姊姊結婚了。兩個小孩都在小學念書。” (*I am Gloria. My older sister is not a student; she works at a bank. My older sister is married. Both children study at elementary school.*) This exposes students to the lesson's key sentences.
2. Lead the class in reading the text aloud; students repeat together. Prepare picture cards to help students understand the text.
3. **Introduce grammar:** Divide the dialogue into sections based on grammar points and teach each part in sequence. First help students understand the meaning and roughly memorize the pronunciation, then reinforce individual grammar structures and vocabulary. For example:
 - (1) Use the situational context to introduce the dialogue:
 - A: Gloria，你姊姊是學生嗎？(*Gloria, is your older sister a student?*)
 - B: 她不是學生，她大學畢業了。(She is not a student; she has graduated from university.)
 - (2) Teacher-student Q&A to help students get familiar with the sentences, memorize meaning, and pronounce accurately.
 - (3) Introduce Grammar Pattern 1 — 不 — and the vocabulary “學生 (student), 大學 (university), 畢業了 (graduated).” Use question-and-answer substitution drills to help students confirm the grammar structure and pay attention to pronunciation.
 - (4) Comprehensively review grammar structures, Chinese characters, and pronunciation with students.
 - (5) Then introduce the following dialogue in sequence, along with Grammar Pattern 2 — 在 — and Grammar Pattern 3 — 都 — and other vocabulary.
4. After leading the class through the text again, ask comprehension questions based on the text.

Sample questions:

- 1. 她姊姊是學生嗎？(*Is her older sister a student?*)
- 2. 她姊姊大學畢業了嗎？(*Has her older sister graduated from university?*)
- 3. 她姊姊在哪裡工作？(*Where does her older sister work?*)
- 4. 她姊姊結婚了嗎？(*Is her older sister married?*)
- 5. 她姊姊有孩子嗎？(*Does her older sister have children?*)
- 6. 兩個孩子都在哪裡念書？(*Where do both children study?*)

Then ask students to answer based on their own situations:

- 8. 你有兄弟姐妹嗎？(*Do you have siblings?*)
- 9. 你哥哥 / 姐姐大學畢業了嗎？(*Has your older brother/sister graduated from university?*)
- 10. 你哥哥 / 姐姐在哪裡工作？(*Where does your older brother/sister work?*)
- 11. 你哥哥 / 姐姐結婚了嗎？(*Has your older brother/sister gotten married?*)

- 12. 他們有孩子嗎? (*Do they have children?*)
 - 13. 他們都在哪裡念書? (*Where do they all study?*)
5. Have students practice reading the text in groups, then have individual students take turns reading aloud; correct pronunciation as needed.
 6. Use the content (facts) from the text to have students practice narration using what they have learned, in order to achieve the lesson's learning objectives. Students should be able to develop not only dialogue but also monologue-style narration.
 - (1) Have students work in pairs to use this lesson's key sentences to cooperatively introduce Gloria's older sister's work and family.
 - (2) The teacher uses word cards or a PPT to provide the necessary vocabulary or phrases and has students produce the following content:
 - a. Gloria 的姊姊不是學生。 (*Gloria's older sister is not a student.*)
 - b. 她在銀行工作。 (*She works at a bank.*)
 - c. 她結婚了。 (*She is married.*)
 - d. 他有兩個孩子，一個兒子，一個女兒。 (*He/She has two children — one son and one daughter.*)
 - e. 兩個小孩都在小學念書。 (*Both children study at elementary school.*)

(*The above content may be adjusted flexibly by the teacher based on students' level and circumstances.*)

 - (3) The structure "Gloria 的姊姊" is something students have not yet learned. The teacher may supplement an explanation in the students' native language (English) as needed.
7. After finishing text instruction, guide students through the grammar exercises to confirm grammar structures.
8. After completing the grammar exercises, explain or demonstrate the stroke order for Chinese characters that have complex structures or that students are likely to make mistakes on.
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V. Integrated Activities

1. (Read Aloud / Sight-Read)

(1) Objective: Students can recognize the sentences in the dialogue without the aid of phonetic notation or romanization, and pronounce them correctly.

(2) Method: - a. Have students practice the dialogue in groups. - b. The teacher calls on students to take turns reading the dialogue aloud.

2. (Fill in the Blanks / Writing)

(1) Objective: After repeating and memorizing the sentences learned in this lesson, students understand the dialogue content and can write the missing parts using Chinese characters or phonetic notation.

(2) Method: - a. Have students fill in the dialogue content. - b. The teacher calls on students to read aloud or write out the answers. - c. Writing characters or phonetic notation may be arranged based on students' level. - d. If time allows, a supplementary activity may be

arranged. For students who learn quickly and are at a higher level, the supplementary activity may replace the original activity. The procedure is the same.

Supplementary Activity (Students add or reduce sentences based on their own situation)

A: 你好！你_____是_____嗎？ (Hello! Is your _____ a _____?)

B: 他_____是學生，他大學_____了。 (He is/isn't a student; he has _____ from university.)

A: 他在_____工作？ (Where does he work?)

B: 我_____在_____工作，他_____在_____工作。 (I _____ work at _____, he _____ works at _____.)

A: 你_____, _____了，那麼，他們有_____嗎？ (You _____, _____ [married], so do they have _____?)

B: 他們有_____個_____, 一個_____, 一個_____. _____個小孩
_____在小學_____. (They have _____ children — one _____ and
one _____. _____ children all _____ study at elementary school.)

3. (Speaking)

(1) Objective: Students can fluently use the sentences learned in this lesson to describe and ask about the work and marital status of themselves and others' family members.

(2) Method: - a. Explain the activity procedure and remind students of the sentences they need to use. - b. After students complete their interviews, have them fill out a form and introduce the student they interviewed to the whole class. - c. Depending on the situation, call on students to complete the dialogue in front of the whole class. The dialogue content can refer to the Supplementary Activity from Integrated Activity 2.

4. (Reading)

(1) Objective: Using authentic materials, train students to identify workplace names and Chinese surnames and given names.

(2) Method: - a. Explain the activity procedure. - b. Have students find the workplace name and person's name on business cards on their own. - c. After students finish, the teacher calls on students to respond. - d. The teacher may ask students additional oral questions about the business card content.

VI. Supplementary Text Instruction

As circumstances allow, the teacher may use the following material as a supplementary reading or listening exercise. The teacher may read the short passage aloud to train students' listening, or make it into a handout for reading practice.

Please read the passage and determine whether the statements below are correct.

Steve 不是學生，他大學畢業了，結婚了。他在電腦公司工作。Steve 有兩個小孩，一個兒子，一個女兒。他們都在小學念書。

(Steve is not a student; he has graduated from university and is married. He works at a computer company. Steve has two children — one son and one daughter. They both study at elementary school.)

Statements: - () 1. Steve 不是學生。 (Steve is not a student.) - () 2. Steve 在學校工作。 (Steve works at a school.) - () 3. Steve 結婚了。 (Steve is married.) - () 4. Steve 有兩個孩子。 (Steve has two children.)

Answers: ○ × ○ ○

VII. Phonetics Instruction / Phonetics Review

1. **Third-tone tone sandhi:** When two third-tone syllables appear together, the first third tone changes to a second tone when spoken aloud. For example: 你好 (nǐ hǎo), 我有 (wǒ yǒu) → spoken as (ㄋˇ ㄏㄠˇ → ㄋˊ ㄏㄠˇ). However, when marking tone symbols, the original third tone is still written — e.g., 你好 (nǐ hǎo), 我有 (wǒ yǒu).
2. **This lesson introduces the following phonetics:**
 - Initials: g, k, h
 - Finals: ai, -uo, ang
 - 1. When -uo has no initial consonant before it, it is written as “wo.” For example: wǒ (我, I/me).
 - 2. When the final is i+ang, if there is no initial consonant, “i” is written as “y.” For example: yīng (英, English/Britain).
3. For phonetic combinations that do not exist in this lesson, try to find examples from vocabulary in other lessons for practice, using as few non-existent Mandarin sound combinations as possible. To practice all four tones of a syllable, some non-existent syllables may appear; the book marks these with parentheses — e.g., (ká), (kái), (hǎng), (wó) — to indicate these syllables do not exist as pronunciations in Mandarin.
4. Use slides or word cards to have students read sentences or words aloud, correcting pronunciation as needed.

參. Answer Key for In-Book Exercises

◆ Grammar Exercise Answers

1. - (1) 132 (2) 231 (3) 3241 (4) 2341 (5) 4132
2. - (1) 1342 (2) 2143 (3) 2314 (4) 1342 (5) 2431
3.
 - 3-1 - (1) 1234 (2) 1324 (3) 2134 (4) 43512 / 53412
 - 3-2 - (1) 2314 (2) 3421 (3) 2314 (4) 21453

◆ Integrated Activity Answers

1. (omitted)
2. **Fill in the Blanks:** 學生 / 不 / 畢業 / 哪裡 / 在 / 工作 / 電腦 / 結婚 / 孩子 (小孩) / 小孩 (孩子) / 兒子 (女兒) / 女兒 (兒子) / 都 / 念書

(student / not / graduated / where / at / work / computer / married / children / children / son (daughter) / daughter (son) / both/all / study)

3. (omitted)

4. (see business card images in original)

◆ Phonetics Exercise Answers

1. Tone Discrimination - (1) (omitted) - (2) kě (可 can) / hē (喝 drink) / gē (哥 older brother) / hái (孩 child) / háng (行 bank/row) / wǒ (我 I) / guò (過 past) - (3) mǎi (買 buy) / huǒ (火 fire) / fāng (方 direction) / duǒ (朵 measure word for flowers) / háng (行 bank/row) / gǎi (改 change) / pài (派 send) / kū (哭 cry)

2. Word Discrimination - (1) kē (科 department) / gē (哥 older brother) / hù (戶 household) / guò (過 past) / táng (堂 hall) / duō (多 many) / gāng (剛 just now) / kǎ (卡 card) - (2) gài (蓋 cover) / tài (太 too/very) / wò (握 grip) / měi (美 beautiful) / hǎo (蒿 artemisia) / lài (賴 rely) / huó (活 live) / kù (庫 warehouse)

肆. Workbook Answer Key

I. Text Comprehension

1. ✕ 2. ○ 3. ○ 4. ✕

II. Tone Discrimination

1. zài (在) / dōu (都) / xué (學) / zuò (作) / xiǎo (小)
2. gōng (公) / nǎo (腦) / xué (學) / xiān (先) / shēng (生)

III. Word Discrimination

1. 1. 兒 (2) 先 (3) 工 (4) 小 (5) 書
2. 1. 女兒 (2) 畢業了 (3) 工作 (4) 大學 (5) 小孩
3. 在 / 電腦 / 都 / 學生 / 孩子

IV. Sentence Restructuring

1. bac 2. cba 3. badc 4. badce 5. dabfce

V. Matching

1. b 2. a 3. e 4. c 5. d

VI. Translation

1. 我姐姐在銀行工作。(My older sister works at a bank.)
2. 她先生在電腦公司工作。(Her husband works at a computer company.)
3. 你姐姐是學生嗎?(Is your older sister a student?)
4. 他們有孩子嗎?(Do they have children?)
5. 他們有兩個孩子，一個兒子、一個女兒。(They have two children — one son and one daughter.)

伍. Test Answer Key

I. Listening

1. jiéhūn le (結婚了 got married)
2. bìyè le (畢業了 graduated)
3. diànnǎo (電腦 computer)
2. yínháng (銀行 bank)
5. érzi (兒子 son)

II. Restructuring

1. cabd
2. adceb
3. dacb
4. cbda
5. daceb

III. Matching

1. c
2. d
3. b
4. a

IV. Dictation

1. 學生 (student)
2. 在哪裡 (where)
3. 工作 (work)
4. 電腦公司 (computer company)
5. 女兒 (daughter)

陸. Supplementary Online Resources

1. Ministry of Education Standard Script Stroke Order Learning Website

<http://stroke-order.learningweb.moe.edu.tw/home.do>

(1) Stroke Order: Characters in this lesson such as “學 (study), 那 (that), 孩 (child), 都 (all)” are prone to stroke order errors among students beginning to learn Chinese characters. The teacher may demonstrate the stroke order in class.

(2) Structure: Write the following characters on the board (or project them) and have students discuss together to find characters that can fit into the same structure. This activity may be expanded based on students' level and available time. The teacher should minimize explanation and let students discuss on their own, finding answers visually. The goal is for students to develop a general sense of top-bottom structured characters; keep the process engaging.

Which of the following characters can fit into the structure below? 美 生 電 腦 念 孩 只 不 兒

(Example: 美 fits a top-bottom structure)

Answer: 電、念、只、兒

2. Chinese Character Story Short Videos

Suitable for beginners. No audio narration — includes character evolution, stroke order, and pronunciation.

- 1. 「大」 (big): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4fSCxr_sdm8
- 2. 「小」 (small): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4Chrx2BDOHs>
- 3. 「不」 (not): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2RB5BtDETnQ>

柒. Supplementary Chinese Character Writing Practice

◎ **Note:** The number of characters practiced for writing varies from lesson to lesson in this textbook. Each lesson places at most 17 characters in the workbook. Other characters that appear in the lesson text but are not placed in the workbook are all listed in the Teacher's Manual. The teacher may decide whether to provide these additional characters to students.

Characters and stroke orders included in this lesson:

Character	Pinyin	Meaning
裡	lǐ	inside / where
銀	yín	silver (as in 銀行 bank)
行	háng	row / (in 銀行: bank)
電	diàn	electricity (as in 電腦 computer)
腦	nǎo	brain (as in 電腦 computer)
公	gōng	public / company
司	sī	manage (as in 公司 company)
畢	bì	finish (as in 畢業 graduate)
業	yè	industry/work (as in 畢業 graduate)
了	le	sentence-final particle
結	jié	tie/knot (as in 結婚 marry)
婚	hūn	marriage
們	men	plural suffix
念	niàn	study/read aloud
書	shū	book (as in 念書 study)
法	fǎ	law/method

(Stroke order grids as shown in the original manual)

Lesson 3 Quiz

Name: _____

I. Listening: Circle the one that you hear.

① jiéhūn le	② biyè le	③ diànnǎo	④ yínháng	⑤ érzi
jiēfèn le	biyè le	diànnào	yīngāng	èrzi

II. Rearrange the following words into sentences.

- 哥哥 大學 我 畢業了 a b c d → _____。
- 她 工作 在 姐姐 銀行 a b c d e → _____。
- 在 工作 哪裡 你 a b c d → _____?
- 嗎 姐姐 你 結婚了 a b c d → _____?
- 孩子 念書 都 兩個 在大學 a b c d e → _____。

III. Match the expression in A with the response in B.

A: 1. 你哥哥是學生嗎？(*Is your older brother a student?*) 2. 你在哪裡工作？(*Where do you work?*) 3. 你姐姐有孩子嗎？(*Does your older sister have children?*) 4. 我姐姐結婚了。(*My older sister is married.*)

B: - a. 她有孩子嗎？(*Does she have children?*) - b. 她有一個兒子，一個女兒。(*She has one son and one daughter.*) - c. 他大學畢業了。(*He has graduated from university.*) - d. 我在電腦公司工作。(*I work at a computer company.*)

Answers: 1-c 2-d 3-b 4-a

IV. Dictation: Write down the characters or pinyin with tone marks.

1. _____ 4. _____

2. _____ 5. _____

3. _____
